

Tribe Coming Home Unsure of Reception

By LESTER KOELLING, News Sportswriter
WICHITA—The Indianapolis Indians will return home tomorrow for a long stand and one of the chief concerns is how will they be received and accepted by Victory Field patrons.

It's always easy to pick a club to pieces when it's going bad, and fault its manager, too. A losing club invariably is subject to derision, to charges of dissension, loafing and carousing. The manager, too, comes in for severe criticism.



Koelling

It was ever thus and ever will be. But to flaunt such charges against the Indians would be unfair, incorrect and ill-timed.

That is not imply that the Indians or their manager are without fault. But there is no dissension, loafing or carousing. What would be more accurate, and more in taste, would be a conclusion that the Indians are lacking in teamwork, spirit and desire.

The Indians have been performing to the best of their ability, and that, being somewhat limited in several cases, apparently hasn't been good enough for this year's torrid American Association race. On top of that, Manager Andy Cohen has had downright-foul luck on much of his strategy.

Manager Cohen's management has prompted eyebrows to rise on occasions and it hasn't always been in accord with the book, with some of the players, and with other observers. But when strategy constantly backfires, it's conceivable why a manager would forsake the conventional, or the book, for more radical maneuvers.

"We are going through a vicious cycle," says Cohen. "We're in one of those periods when everything goes wrong for you. We have found more ways to lose games than any club I ever managed."

Some of his moves may raise a question as to whether Cohen is a good manager. But had they panned out, he would be

rated a genius. Yet, were the moves good baseball in the first place? For each that he makes, Cohen has an explanation that at the time rings reasonable and plausible.

A complete and final judgment on Cohen as a manager and the Indians as players hardly seems proper at this time. One important angle to be considered is that the Indians haven't been at full playing strength since May 26 when Jim Delsing pulled a leg muscle that started a string of injuries which, to this day, continues to plague them.

In some of their most disheartening defeats on this trip, the Indians were playing a catcher at third base and, on one occasion, a pitcher in the outfield. Also, there is the realization now that several of the boys are not quite ready for Triple A baseball.

The Indians have too many weaknesses to be rated a good club, but again, they are as good as their limitations and capabilities will allow. To advance any higher in the A.A. standings, they will need reinforcements at several positions and much more confidence and desire. They also need someone to instill the latter two requirements.

Heavy rains here forced postponement of last night's game with the Braves, much to the delight of Manager Cohen and the ailing Indians. But a double-header is booked to-night with Bill DuFour and Barry Latman, the youngsters who beat Minneapolis in a twin bill last Sunday, scheduled for mound duty. On their return home tomorrow, the Indians will open a four-game series with Louisville.

Rain Tightens A.A. Chase

By Associated Press
If you thought the American Association baseball race was tight yesterday, look at it to-day.

While St. Paul's leaders watched rain postpone their game at Omaha, Minneapolis scored a 10-5 victory over Denver to move within 5 percentage points of the Saints.

That left the Millers tied in second place with Wichita.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION STANDINGS

	Won	Lost	Pct.	G.B.
St. Paul	40	28	.588	
Wichita	47	30	.563	
Minneapolis	42	30	.583	
Omaha	38	31	.551	2 1/2
Denver	35	31	.530	4